

R A M B L E S
IN
W A L T H A M F O R E S T.

A
STRANGER'S CONTRIBUTION
TO
THE TRIENNIAL SALE
FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE
Manstead Lying-in Charity.

"Silver and gold have I none;—but such as I have, give I thee."

ACTS, iii. 6.

LONDON:
PRINTED BY J. L. COX, 75, GREAT QUEEN STREET,
LINCOLN'S-INN FIELDS.

1827.

R A M B L E S
IN
W A L T H A M F O R E S T.

A
STRANGER'S CONTRIBUTION

TO
THE TRIENNIAL SALE

FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE

Manstead Lying-in Charity.

“Silver and gold have I none;—but such as I have, give I thee.”
Acts, iii. 6.

LONDON:
PRINTED BY J. L. COX, 75, GREAT QUEEN STREET,
LINCOLN'S-INN FIELDS.
1827.

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Rambles in Waltham Forest

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Rambles in Waltham Forest

a stranger's contribution to the triennial sale for the benefit
of the Wanstead Lying-in Charity

Author: Countess of Marguerite Blessington

Release date: February 11, 2025 [eBook #75349]

Language: English

Original publication: London: J. L. Cox, 1827

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/75349

Credits: Richard Tonsing and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net> (This book was produced from images made available by the HathiTrust Digital Library.)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK RAMBLES IN
WALTHAM FOREST ***

Transcriber's Note:

New original cover art included with this eBook is granted to the public domain.

RAMBLES
IN
WALTHAM FOREST.

A
STRANGER'S CONTRIBUTION

TO
THE TRIENNIAL SALE

FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE
Wanstead Lying-in Charity.

“Silver and gold have I none;—but such as I have, give I thee.”

ACTS,
i
i
i
.
6
.

LONDON:
PRINTED BY J. L. COX, 75, GREAT QUEEN STREET,

LINCOLN'S-INN FIELDS.

1827.

WALTHAM FOREST.

Land of soft showers and far-extending vales,
And woodlands fanned by summer's gentlest gales,
And streams, that glisten as they steal, half hid
The tangled brake and waving sedge amid;
Land!—where rich plenty with abounding flow, 5
Bids 'neath her smile the golden meadow glow,
And from the juicy herbage—Nature's wealth!
Draws the pure stream of sustenance and health;
Land—where, beneath Wealth's hospitable dome, 10
Refinement dwells, and Science finds a home,—
In whose sweet sylvan shades the classic Muse
Her richer buds upon thy green lap strews;
With thy soft breath her tuneful whisper blends,
And to the Poet's home her brightness lends,—
Smiles at his hearth, dispels the gath'ring tear, 15
And—dating all from Heaven—makes one *here*.
Nor fears the power of her spell will cease,
Breathed from the altar of domestic peace;^[1]
Land! where my pilgrim foot in peace hath strayed, 20
And traced out many a fresh and grassy glade,
Smiling in sunlight, whilst, like former dreams,
Dimly afar the mighty City gleams;
Where o'er its lines the dancing sunbeams play,
Gilding each roof with morning's brilliant ray—
I hail thee!—not mine own—but still dear clime! 25
Fair spread thy vales! and bright thy waters shine!
Thy flowers,—thy glens, and health-restoring breeze

Fraught with the song of birds, the hum of bees,
 The low of kine, and voices clear and sweet,
 That link us to the world in our retreat,— 30
 These, and the grateful spell—that magic zone—
 Of social pleasures o'er thy beauties thrown—
 Endear thy shades, and give thy forest bowers
 The tranquil charm of gay and guiltless hours.
 Peaceful the day rolls here! and Friendship's tongue— 35
 That sweetest music!—breathes thy glades among,
 Charming life's harsher discords into peace;
 Bidding anxiety's sad warning cease,—
 Twining with wreaths of hope a falling shrine,
 Crowning with flowers the pale cold brow of Time. 40
 I love thy calm! The storm-beat pinnacle, driven
 Before the stern breath of the threat'ning heaven,
 Lies in some little bay, whose waters sleep,
 Cradled by rocks from the surrounding deep:
 And thus thy gentle shades seem formed to be 45
 A quiet haven from a troubled sea.
 Here Nature walks in brightness, and each star
 Is as an altar, lit by her afar,
 To His great name who bound the radiant sphere.
 Each on its path foreknown, their song we hear 50
 Hymning along the pure and cloudless sky
 The awful story of their mystery;
 For the mind tracks them, as their course they take,
 E'en as with tongues of men their voices spake.
 Then,—Day!—with her bright chaplet's rosy braid, 55
 In all her living hues of light arrayed,
 Comes fresh o'er the green heath, and shakes the dew
 From her light sandall'd foot, whose blushing hue
 Seems as she trod on roses.—And, at eve,
 With ling'ring steps, as weary pilgrims leave 60
 The shrine they love, calm sinks the sun's last ray,
 And dovelike silence soothes the wearied day;
 And Time's swift sand in noiseless current flows,

There is nought here to break the still repose.—
 Nought of the stir—the strife—the mental war— 65
 Of that vast Babylon, scarce seen afar;
 Where on the blue horizon's distant verge,
 Its cloudy breath floats like a rolling surge;
 And in dim majesty its sacred dome,
 As it would rise to seek a purer home, 70
 Soaring sublime above the denser sky—
 A type of Time and Immortality!—
 Beams through the yellow mist, and brings again
 The dreams of splendour—affluence—pleasure—gain.
 And better visions:—for within thy walls, 75
 London! the silent, secret blessing falls
 Promised to those who, bowing not the knee
 To Baal, 'mid the land's idolatry,
 The scoff of science, and the smile of pride,—
 The flash of wit, and talent misapplied,— 80
 Blush not to own, to serve with humble zeal
 (Impressed with self-denial's graven seal)
 The God who formed them! nor reject the hand
 That beckons onward t'wards the promised land;
 And, pierced for us,—sets the world's captive free— 85
His hardest service this—"believe on me."
 Aye, there be many 'mid thy darkest cells,
 City, where ev'ry vice and sorrow dwells!
 Who bind the harvest in no pleasant field,
 Reaping with tears the increase it may yield! 90
 Yet on the tablets of the age record—
 "I and my house will humbly serve the Lord!"
 Amid thy darkness bid Truth brightly shine,
 Strong to redeem the evil of the time.
 Vast City! from my dwelling's quiet shade 95
 I see thee in thy cloudy pomp arrayed,
 And scarce can deem thy rush of crowds so near,
 Whilst nought but Nature's voice is stirring here!
 And bees, and birds, and forest glades are nigh,

To soothe the ear and tempt the gladden'd eye.	100
Here the fawn looks from out the blossom'd brakes,—	
From dewy lawns the lark's clear hymn awakes;	
The dimpling stream marks where the bright fish glide,	
And the fair lily clusters o'er its tide;	
The kine in scatter'd groups, with patient gaze,	105
Shine, golden-chestnut, in the sun's glad rays;	
And the gale breathes as fresh, the sky as bright,	
As if no fane of Mammon met the sight!	
No city on the dimm'd horizon lay	
A cloud, which but a breeze might waft away:	110
So faint the trace of yon stupendous mart,	
Where gold can buy—all!—genius—fame, and art!	
And yet, fair scenes! these charms so well thine own,	
Live to the many slandered or unknown;	
Capricious Fancy, with fantastic choice,	115
For distant beauties, gives her casting voice;	
To the remotest shores our isle supplies	
Turns the faint gaze of her long dazzled eyes;	
Shuns the rich plenty of a daily feast,	
What most attainable, still valued least!	120
When from the thronged metropolis we rove	
To seek the healthful gale, and bow'ry grove;	
By the far Lakes, or Caledonia's shore,	
She bids our steps her mazy path explore;	
In Katrine's mirror watch the mountains sleep,	125
And wander on Helvellyn's mighty steep;	
Or where the belting Severn rolls sublime	
Her copious stream, full as the tide of time,	
By rock and headland wander idly by;—	
Or trace thy bowers—my own romantic Wye!	130
Oh pardon!—no false renegade to thee,	
With well pleased eye these milder shades I see;—	
Their's is the grace of Nature, deck'd by art,	
But thou art ever nearest to my heart!	
And I the well-remember'd past should wrong,	135

Neglecting thee, e'en in a transient song!
 Oh! who could silent pass a scene less fair,
 If life had dawned, and hope had blossom'd there!
 If youth's bright flowers in gay variety
 Thy soil had nursed—no matter *where* to die, 140
 If happiness—that gift of early years!
 Had marked each scene which contrast more endears;
 If long-loved voices seem to haunt the place,
 And forms *there* hover, which no hand may trace;
 If the dread seal of the all-silent grave, 145
 Still uneffaced by Time's slow-rolling wave,
 Had marked the lines of some one treasur'd spot
 On memory's tablet;—who that page would blot!
 No;—far from my fond hand to snatch one gem
 From thy soft beauty's regal diadem: 150
 Queen of the rock! nymph of the silent shade!
 Muse of the glen where my young feet have strayed;
 Though now, a pilgrim, from those paths I fly,
 'Mid all the goodly scenes that greet mine eye,
 Their rich variety of vale and hill— 155
 Thy smile is brightest—purest—loveliest still!
 Away—thy banks I may not linger near;
 Sweet stream! whose murmurs yet are on my ear;—
 The scene around me, rich in autumn's glow,
 Untrack'd by path, unbroken by the plough, 160
 Where all unseen the pensive foot may roam,
 Is best befitting a recluse's home.
 It is a place of trees; their sweeping boughs
 Clash in the autumn's gusts, their crowned brows
 Rise upon ev'ry steep, and throng the glade 165
 With a rich mass of varied light and shade.
 I love the wildness of the far spread scene:
 Now lost, now caught the golden checquer'd beam,
 Dancing the mossy trunks and boughs amid,
 And now in depths of thicker verdure hid; 170
 Whilst the far rolling of the laden wain,

Rich in its autumn store of golden grain,
 Or the faint sound of the revolving wheel
 Through the low-sighing branches seems to steal
 Broken and fitful, o'er the extatic song 175
 Of the free lark, his summer clouds among.
 I love thee, Land! and where such beauties shine,
 Ask not, in niggard phrase, if thou art mine?
 That here the eye is pleased—the foot is free—
 And the pulse healthful, is enough for me! 180
 Yet art thou wrong'd—the pen, that seal of fame
 Whose magic impress gilds or blights a name,
 Hath stricken thee;^[2]—a base and coward dart!
 I fain would pluck the arrow from thy heart;
 Erase th' accusing blot with just applause, 185
 Nor spare a lance to skirmish in thy cause!
 Oh! say not health avoids this balmy gale,
 Or flies the pathway down that dewy vale!
 Skim o'er the plain! thread the wide mazy heath,
 Bright with her smile, and fragrant with her breath! 190
 Doubt the dry slander of the technic sage,
 And, closing his, read Nature's gentler page!
 Come with me where, o'er blythe and fertile meads,
 My step untired the mould'ring abbey^[3] leads;
 Shorn of its beams, still o'er its woods it tow'rs, 195
 A wreck, which yet recalls its prouder hours.
 Gaze on the sculptur'd arch, the massive aisle,
 The niche where saint or martyr seemed to smile;
 (Dwellers in heaven, and only called below
 Our faith to strengthen, or to soothe our woe;) 200
 The plunder'd altar in its fall behold,
 Once heaped with far-sought relics, gems, and gold;
 Where a king knelt,^[4] the penance vow to pay,
 And the mailed warrior came his spoils to lay;
 Where the doomed Saxon, zealous for his race, 205
 Deemed he endowed their last proud dwelling-place;
 With wealth—and lands—enriched the holy shrine

Where he should sleep—the latest of his line!
 Come to that vacant shrine—though—such the doom
 Of greatness—here we trace not *e'en his tomb!* 210
 All that this pile so changed can now record,
 Is that, bowed down before the Norman's sword,
 Here the pale mother, with vain fondness, gave
 Her murder'd Harold that sad boon—a grave!
 Or, turning from the deeds of other days, 215
 Towards yon deep groves direct the pensive gaze.
 Come with me where, from many a foreign clime,
 The varied marbles rise, the gildings shine;
 To the free sky and laughing summer's beam,
 The paintings glow, the costly frescoes gleam; 220
 And, by the idle winds of heaven laid bare,
 Pomp's gaudy pageant smiles in mock'ry there.
 WANSTEAD!—thou spell to stay mirth's flowing tide,
 Warning!—to daunt the regal brow of pride,
 Ruin!—which sunk in premature decay, 225
 From ev'ry levell'd column seems to say:
 "Thus human wisdom plans for endless time,
 "Thus vice and folly mar the proud design;"
 'Tis good to wander through thy palace bowers,
 And tread the site of thy once stately towers! 230
 From thy thick shades what mournful thoughts arise!
 Through thy far groves the sounding axe replies;
 Down sinks the pile! and ruin spreads o'er all
 The silence of its dark funereal pall.
 Dower of woe! a rich but fatal boon, 235
 The "gilding fretted from the toy too soon;"
 Is this thy wreck, a beacon, raised to tell
 How vain the wealth—the pomp—we love so well?
 How *nothing* all the splendour and the taste,
 Once redolent upon this mournful waste! 240
 Turn to your humbler roofs! and bless your lot,
 Ye, who can claim the bliss-ennobled cot!
 If, 'neath the russet thatch and lowly dome,

Peace—and her sister virtue, make their home;
 Lament not thou thy board of frugal fare, 245
 But with full heart ask heaven's blessing there!
 Thy prayer as free will come, as pure will rise,
 As if through column'd roofs it sought the skies.
 It is not marble—sculpture—painting—gold—
 Can deck the page of life by time unrolled! 250
 And grandeur moulders—levelled with the mean,
 To warn us of the reed on which we lean.
 Alas! *her* breast who owned this wide domain
 Sighed for the calm of cottage homes in vain!
 She dwelt within this master-piece of art 255
 With blighted visions—and a breaking heart.
 Turned on its pomps a faint accusing eye,
 And asked—and vainly asked—in peace to die.
 Come, from this scene so desolately fair,
 Where through “the Grove”^[5] soft plays the summer air; 260
 And wooingly the sun with ev'ry breeze
 Kisses the glad leaves of the whisp'ring trees;
 Gilding their trunks, and on each dewy spray
 Hanging a gem that sparkles in his ray.
 There the magnolia's snowy blossoms gleam, 265
 Amid their glossy leaves' umbrageous screen;
 There the pale orange scents the languid gales,
 And starry jasmine its sweet breath exhales;
 There the rich tribes of far Columbia's plain,
 In clustering bloom awake to life again; 270
 Glow the acacia's trembling shade beneath,
 Or through the crimson sumach's palm-like leaf;
 On the bright turf a gem-like radiance throw,
 And glisten on the tranquil wave below.
 Trace thou that bowery vista's green alcove! 275
 Through the long avenue in silence rove—
 Look through the woven boughs' fine tracery,
 On the clear, blue, and joy-inspiring sky!
 Oh, lovely face of Nature!—who can view

Thy smile rejoicing, nor be happy too? 280
 What heart can thy enduring wonder scan,
 And see unrolled thy wide and glorious plan;
 Bask in thy glow, drink in thy living hues,
 Yet the deep homage of the heart refuse,
 To Him, who in such loveliness arrayed 285
 Those charms of thine, which guilt alone could fade;
 And, e'er thy sin-bought doom of change began,
 Saw thou wert good, and gave the boon to man!
 By the green margin of that fairy lake,
 List!—for the lark's wild music is awake, 290
 And the low murmur of the ring-dove's note
 Steals musically, from her shade remote;
 The willow-spray upon the calm wave sleeps,
 The gilded trout from its still mirror leaps;
 Bright wings are glancing the free boughs among, 295
 And bills of happy birds make one glad song!
 It is the home of Taste; her wand has laid
 A gentler beauty o'er the sylvan shade;
 Bade the fair trees in richer masses grow,
 With brighter hues the painted flowers glow; 300
 No gilding strikes, no marbles court the eye,
 But, rich alone in Nature's symmetry,
 To this retreat the fabled Nymphs repair,
 And deem they find their long-lost Tempe there;
 Hang o'er the brink of the transparent waves, 305
 Sleep where the pendant rose its garland laves;
 Or idly on the velvet margin stray,
 And watch the gentle waters glide away.
 Not here the pomp of Grandeur's cumbrous state,
 Here gentle Peace and polished Taste await. 310
His mind who planned this smiling solitude
 With that pure feeling that directs the good;
 On Nature's brow the votive chaplet placed,
 And loved the spot by her soft beauty graced;
 Turned from the stately dome—the busy crowd— 315

And to a simpler shrine in homage bowed;
 With true ambition earned a purer fame,
 Whilst the poor bless their benefactor's name!
 And here the gentle smile of Courtesy
 Still holds the spell-bound step and gladden'd eye. 320
 Taste, which with never-sated eye explores
 The changeful loveliness of distant shores;
 Yet, like the bee, how far soe'er it roam,
 Treasures their varied spoils to deck its home;
 Taste and refinement give the rosy hours 325
 A winged speed in these delightful bowers!
 Here gentle converse in soft witchery blends;
 Here rank with graceful suavity descends;
 Nor, with the jealousy of meanness, deems
 Its splendour lessened by the smile it beams! 330
 With true nobility of mind, unknown
 To pride, not *firmly* seated on its throne,
 With its warm smile the less distinguished cheers,
 Exacting, claiming naught, the more endears;
 And with real dignity's resistless sway, 335
Deserves the homage that we gladly pay.
 Here in the social circle gaily meet
 The polished ease that makes the hours so fleet;
 Wit's harmless play, and music's tuneful spell,
 That whisper'd magic the heart knows so well! 340
 And the sweet pencil's ever-pleasing trace,
 Which makes eternal, beauty's transient grace,
 Here bids the flower in fresher bloom and hue,
 On the fair page its flush of life renew;
 Whilst many an alpine height and distant plain, 345
 Touched by the hand of genius, smiles again.
 Here too, on walls bright with the ev'ning rays,
 Thy magic wand of classic fancy plays
 Angelica!^[6] whose pencil's graceful line
 Gives life and tint to sculpture's chaste design; 350
 Here thine Arcadian groups and attic scenes

Seem the Elysium of a poet's dreams,
 The fair embodied forms which fancy shews,
 When the pleased mind luxuriates in repose,
 When bright romance the 'witching harp has strung 355
 And o'er the bard her robe of glamour flung.
 But now—'tis not from fiction's flow'ry urn
 The cup I fill! To truth's pure stream I turn;
 For WANSTEAD! thy embowering shades amid,
 'Wake dearer feelings, deeper thoughts lie hid! 360
 It may be from my chosen theme I stray,
 On friendship's shrine a votive wreath to lay;
 A wreath unworthy of a shrine so dear,
 And placed, perhaps, with failing courage here.
 For what have the soul's treasured thoughts to do 365
 With the calm page that meets the stranger's view?
 But could I pass that spot unnoted by,
 Dear to my heart, and welcome to mine eye;
 And when with honoured names the lay I twine,
 Refuse to gem the braid—loved friend—with thine! 370
 My friend of many years! when yet a child,
 To me life's far perspective only smiled;
 When (all my paradise of being, met
 In that maternal love which soothes me yet;
 That cherished parent's dear and tender care, 375
 Which then, as now, my ev'ry hope would share)
 No tongue of change, and altered feelings, told,
 No lip smiled proudly, and no eye glanced cold;
 When with glad hand I loosed the silken sail,
 And launched my bark on pleasure's sportive gale; 380
 Fearing no coming gloom on wave or sky,
 No blasts unkind my fairy pinnance nigh.
 'Twas thine to point the doom of all below,
 The sentence—e'en when writ on flowers—of "woe;"—
 That fatal word, howe'er we hide the smart, 385
 So deeply graven on the human heart;
 That cull each bud! joy's sparkling goblet fill

In vain! for there we read the legend still.
 'Twas thine who, as the child in stature grew,
 Held truth's clear mirror to my dazzled view; 390
 Warned me of fancy's too prevailing sway,
 Whispered how evanescent youth's bright day!
 And told me that the scene I deemed so fair,
 Had many a thorn of trial lurking there.
 Instructress! from whose lips improvement came, 395
 And study lost the rigour of its name,
 Friend! still by time and circumstance untried,
 Forgive the homage of a filial pride!
 Forgive, if from the brief excursive lay
 I pause, love's light and willing debt to pay. 400
 My minstrel harp in vain would ask my care,
 If memory's were a chord forbidden there;
 And little worth, that heartless verse, I deem,
 Unconsecrate by friendship's steady beam.
 No! vain the varied wreath of tuneful song 405
 If the heart's language speak not with the tongue!
 Without true feeling, bright the page may be,
 But 'tis a cold and fickle brilliancy,
 The dazzling light of the sun's glancing rays,
 When on the glacier's arrowy point it plays; 410
 Oh! fairer far that sun's refulgent lines,
 Where on the cotter's roof its brightness shines,
 Gilding the village green, the ivied tower,
 Tipping with light each blade and dewy flower;
 Smiling in sweet repose, his glad adieu, 415
 All nature radiant with his glowing hue.
 Thus cheering, bright'ning o'er earth's darker soil,
 Affection's sunbeam gilds our daily toil;
 That arduous post we all are called to fill,
 In the set battle betwixt good and ill! 420
 Vain *there* the subtlest panoply of proof,
 Take thou nor spear, nor buckler, save the truth.
 What are thy vaunted saws—Philosophy!

Summed up and brought before the Christian's eye?
 What all the comeliness of human schemes 425
 For living, dying tranquilly?—what!—*dreams!*
 Impostors! swallowed by the Aaron's rod
 Of that one simple axiom—"trust in God."
 In *His* pure worship even sorrow heals,
 And the heart lightens with the pang it feels; 430
 Unlike the trifles that our minds employ,
 Ending in sorrow, though begun in joy,
 Religion pours a balm with ev'ry tear,
 And reaps her golden harvest even here!
 Give me one hour in holy converse spent, 435
 For a whole age of indolent content!
 Give me the friend who guides my steps aright,
 Nor fears to bring my errors to my sight:
 With tenderness the heart's fond guile unrobes,
 But to the core with steady courage probes, 440
 Points, as my path, not that I *wish* to see,
 But the unbending *right*, as thou to me,
 My long-loved friend! whose roof, a second home,
 More welcome smiles than wealth's most costly dome.
 Full long the pilgrim's sandall'd foot would tread, 445
 Thy wood-paths, WANSTEAD, by affection led;
 But hark! yon deep and silent woods among,
 Wakes the low music of the poet's song;
 The breath of his sweet lyre, on breezes borne,
 Floats, where of old the hunter's stirring horn^[7] 450
 Called to the echoes, that through dell and glade
 Spake in their jocund tongues, from every shade.
 Whilst knight and damsel, in their vests of green,
 Throng'd, gay and graceful, round their huntress-queen;
 And the proud stag caught from afar the strain, 455
 Tossed his broad brow, and sought his woods again.
 There now the hind, in fern-clad hollows hid,
 Couches the pendant weeds and flowers amid,
 Or tripping light, her velvets gemmed with dew,

With a shy wildness glances on the view, 460
 Turns her fair neck with momentary gaze,
 Then plunges in the covert's verdant maze;
 There now the pheasant's shrilly note is heard,
 There in blest freedom lives each happy bird;
 The partridge brings in peace her covey there, 465
 And fears no danger but the fox's lair;
 No thundering gun the startled echoes know,
 And e'en the timid lev'ret dreads no foe.
 Come! when the moon in silvery lustre sleeps,
 And climb with me the forest's mossy steeps; 470
 There, o'er the dewy turf, all bathed in light,
 The playful hare scuds from the stranger's sight,
 Or calmly pastures on the glist'ning blade,
 Whilst the lone owl hoots from his ivied shade.
 'Neath yon wide oak the deep'ning shadows dwell, 475
 And darkly glance upon the "brocket well,"
 That from the twisted roots its stream distils,
 Nursed in the bosom of the shelt'ring hills;
 Whilst on that brow the beeches' lofty height,
 Waves in the clearness of the azure night; 480
 And in wild murmurs sigh the fresh'ning gales,
 Through the deep arches of their leafy aisles.
 Come to the poet's study! no proud dome
 Rich in the polish'd lore of Greece and Rome,
 And painting's wonders, sculpture's magic grace, 485
 Which bids the rock a god's bright features trace.
 No, here, beneath the "branching elms star-proof,"
 Rises in peace the low and simple roof;
 Birds sing above, and flowers blossom nigh,
 And the blue glimpses of the cloudless sky 490
 Through woven boughs and russet thatch look forth,
 Like thoughts of heav'n amid the cares of earth!
 And here pure thoughts and holiest visions come,
 And find within this grot their tranquil home;
 Here not the fever of excited minds 495

Its baleful food in headlong passion finds,
 To poison turns the flower'd chalice, given
 To the bard's hand by an all-bounteous heaven,
 Changing that magic, that might heal the soul,
 To Comus' mocking rod and Circe's bowl. 500
 Oh! better far! here o'er the poet's lyre,
 Hovers a ray of purer, brighter, fire;
 And lips that glow with genius' heaven-sprung flame,
 Breathe back the sacred incense whence it came!
 But ye! who with my lay have wandered on, 505
 That lay is spent, the pilgrim's shrine is won.
 Not now, not now, beside Castalia's streams,
 I ask a fabled muse to aid my dreams,
 Or spread on poesy's too frolic gale
 The varied woof of fancy's tissued sail, 515
 Or bid the star-led bark of fairy land,
 Glide in wild music, from the lonely strand.
 In Nature's praise I frame the simple lay,
 Through her delightful paths in freedom stray;
 Weaving my garland, in whose braid I twine 520
 Names, that might blush to gem a wreath of mine,
 Did not true fame shun the pretender's boast,
 Exacting least where it might claim the most.
 Let such forgive, that on their native plain
 A stranger's lute takes up the votive strain! 525
 Not mine to wake the poet's golden lyre,
 Its thrilling chords, and soul-ennobling fire;
 Or its sweet sorrow, like the ev'ning's breath,
 Or dew, upon the light and glossy leaf;
 Not mine the power to weave the tuneful spell, 530
 And draw a spirit from the sounding shell;
 No! to my trembling fingers give instead
 The oaten stop and simple shepherd's reed!
 I have no muse but Truth;—I ask no art
 To write her lessons on the gentle heart; 535
 Simple and plain in her own strength she stands,

Nor needs the weak support of human hands.
 A granite column, firm and unadorned,
 As if the pomp of ornament she scorned;
 Truth borrows not the glare of gems or gold, 540
 Her name, a charm that needs but to be told!
 And with her,—inmates of the humble cell,
 Where, linked in love, the Christian graces dwell;—
 That best and loveliest, whose welcome feet
 The mountain tops in rays of gladness greet, 545
 As o'er the earth her noiseless step is stayed,
 Healing each bitter wound that sin has made,
 Comes;—like the rainbow o'er the stormy cloud!
 Or pardon to the wretch in fetters bowed;
 Or the sweet dash of waters on the ear, 550
 Gladd'ning the desert-pilgrim's path of fear.—
 Whilst earth rejoices, smiles the bright'ning sky
 Beneath thy step—benignant Charity!
 Can'st *thou* want advocates?—Did not the voice
 Which bade fall'n nature in her bonds rejoice, 555
 And, graven on her page of trial, see
 “Health to the stricken!—set the pris'ner free!”
 Did not that voice, which sin's fast bondage brake,
 And bade, from death's deep rest, the slumb'rer wake,
 Without *this chieftest* all our gifts declare 560
 As tinkling metal, or as tinsel's glare?
 Is there a duty, nearer than the rest,
 Whose links are twined so close about the breast?
 In the fair structure of creation's plan,
 Uniting all, and binding man to man? 565
 'Tis this!—By this to us our God has given
 A portion of the privilege of heaven,
 The joy of blessing!—He, who wipes the tear
 From every mourner's brow who sorrows here,
 Intrusts the sceptre to his creature's hand, 570
 “Go and do likewise!” His benign command,
 In fellowship with man, his task partakes

Wherever Charity's pure zeal awakes;
 How poor soe'er the votive cup, its brim
 O'erflows with wine, if poured from love to Him; 575
 And He is with us in the humblest deed
 That serves mankind, *His* smile our golden meed!
 If strong, this fairest virtue's earnest claim,
 Ah—let not *here* her cause be urged in vain!
 Shall we the less her soft'ning influence feel, 580
 Because the weak are objects of our zeal?
 Because the poor—the sick—the suffering, plead
 Through her, to us, in this their hour of need?
 Ye!—in whose softer bosoms ought to move
 The tranquil whispers of a purer love; 585
 Ye!—to whose gentler fost'ring hand 'tis given
 To shield the plant whose native clime is heaven;
 Its tender shoots to bind with sweet control,
 And for its future Eden fit the soul;
 Upon whose bosom its soft form reclines, 590
 Sheltered from gathering clouds, and rending winds.
 Ye!—who hang o'er these blossoms of your love,
 And trust to see them perfected above,
 Say—can ye gaze upon your happy home,
 A mother's hopes, and quiet pleasures own; 595
 From infancy's soft lips that dear name hear,
 Its half-formed accents blessed to your ear!
 And sweet its cares implied, nor turn to those
 Who bear—in poverty—a mother's woes?
 Daughter of wealth!—whose breast hath never known 600
 Want's bitter pang, misfortune's stifled groan;
 If,—in the fountain of thy woman's heart
 Pity and sympathising love have part,—
 When such a claim we proffer—pass not by
 Or turn away with cold averted eye! 605
 Go—open Nature's book, and she will tell
 How potent is Compassion's silent spell;
 Making worth nobler,—loveliness more fair,

And talent brighter for the tear they spare.
 Or in a richer volume, humbly read 610
 The blessing promised to one kindly deed;
 Not unrequited, for the master's sake
 We give the cup, his pilgrim's thirst to slake.
 And when Benevolence, with accents bland,
 Endears the largess of the ready hand, 615
 The off'ring on no barren shrine is laid,
 The vow to no ungracious master paid;
 But the Redeemer's mild approving smile
 Beams on the sacrifice and lights the pile.
 And infancy is sacred, for it drew 620
 A blessing down—in the assembled view
 Of those first gleaners in the promised land,
 His true disciples' firm united band
 The Saviour stood—with brow serene and mild,
 And held amid the crowd, "a little child." 625
 And as upon his tranquil breast it lay
 With dimpled lip and eye of placid ray,
 Confiding, fearless, in his tender care,
 Thus spake,—“Behold! the Christian's model there!
 Be as this babe in gentleness and love, 630
 For such shall form my heritage above;
 And whosoe'er with pitying eye shall see
 But one—the least of these—receiveth me!
 And from the Father's hand, with blessing stored,
 May claim the faithful servant's rich reward.” 635
 Go then—when charity and mercy plead
 Be the heart strong to prompt the bounteous deed!
 Fear not to trust its inmost whispers there,
 But all its energy and fervour share;
 Happy!—one bosom flower to cull at last 640
 O'er which the blight of sin hath never passed!
 Happy—that from this fount of pain and woe
 A stainless stream may still in brightness flow;
 Happy!—in memory's wreath one bud to set

On which the bloom of Eden lingers yet!

645

NOTES.

“Breathed from the altar of domestic peace.”—page [2](#).

[1](#). Whoever has had the privilege of a visit to Fair Mead Lodge, will feel that Essex has the honour of being the chosen residence of at least one poet, who, in this age of independance and human perfectability, is not too proud to “look through Nature up to Nature’s God.”

*“The pen,—
Hath stricken thee.”— page [9](#).*

[2](#). Dr. Armstrong, the physician-poet, has fulminated an alarming denunciation against poor Essex; witness the startling allegory of the ague in his “Art of Preserving Health.” The countenances of the natives are fair commentaries, not to establish, but to controvert his doctrine. That there are some marshy districts within the two hundred and twenty-five miles of its circumference is indisputable, but it is hard to threaten a whole country with the unacceptable visits of “the meagre fiend Quartana,” who is represented by the Doctor as domesticated there.

“My step untired the mould’ring abbey leads.”—page [10](#).

[3](#). Waltham Abbey, first founded by Tovi, standard-bearer to Canute, for the reception of a holy cross, brought thither, say the learned, by a miracle.—Edward the Confessor gave it to Harold, who enriched it with amazing wealth; and, falling at the battle of Hastings, was, with his

brothers, buried in the Abbey his zeal had almost re-endowed, by their mother Githa. His tomb of stone was some years since to be seen.

“Where a king knelt, the penance vow to pay.”—page [10](#).

[4](#). Henry II. having vowed to *erect* an Abbey to the honour of God and Saint Thomas-à-Becket, as an expiation for the crime of that prelate’s death, seems, skilfully enough, to have construed his vow with a prudent attention to his own interests; for he came to Waltham Abbey on the Vigils of Pentecost, June the 3d 1177, and having procured a charter of Pope Alexander the Third, changed the old foundation of seculars of the Benedictine order, to an Abbey of regular canons of the order of Saint Augustin, increasing the number to sixteen. At the same time, it must be allowed, he enriched the church with many new manors, re-endowed, (Stow says, rebuilt it) and promised to augment its revenue, till it should support one hundred canons. This last promise, the king, with his numerous avocations, *forgot*.

“Where through ‘the Grove’ soft plays the summer air.”—page [13](#).

[5](#). Wanstead Grove, the seat of the Hon. Mrs. Rushout, and formerly the residence of George Bowles, Esq., a residence justly distinguished for the public spirit and benevolence of its late, and the amenity and elegant taste of its present owner.

“Angelica! whose pencil’s graceful line.”—page [17](#).

[6](#). A rich collection of Angelica Kauffman’s most exquisite pieces commemorate the liberal patronage she received from the former possessor of the mansion; nor are her works in a spot where they cannot be fully enjoyed and appreciated.

“Floats, where of old the hunter’s stirring horn.”—page [21](#).

7. Fair-Mead Lodge, the residence of Wm. Sotheby, Esq., preserves the memory of a spot from whence Queen Elizabeth and her ladies, when hunting in the forest, were wont to station themselves, to witness the chase. The Queen's Lodge, farther in the forest, occupies a high ground amongst some fine trees. A dilapidated farmhouse is now the only relic of the royal mansion, and the scene where Leicester "drew his 'broidered rein" beside the palfrey of that Queen he would fain have governed, is now a lonely rabbit-warren. The outlines of the garden parterres and a fish-pond are still to be traced.

FINIS.

LONDON:

PRINTED BY J. L. COX, GREAT QUEEN STREET.

TRANSCRIBER'S NOTES

- Typos fixed; non-standard spelling and dialect retained.
- Line 515 should be renumbered as line 510. Subsequent lines should be numbered accordingly, starting from 515. The original numbering was not corrected.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK RAMBLES
IN WALTHAM FOREST ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS
WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying

with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project

Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the

requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of

obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses,

including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND

- If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you ‘AS-IS’, WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT

LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new

computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.